



Project Manager User Manual

Plugin "LayerConvert"

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ANTLOG AG, CH-6006 Lucerne, Switzerland, March 2011

1 Foreword

Dear customer, dear prospective customer, Thank you

for choosing to use the Project Manager and its "LayerConvert" plugin. Please read this manual carefully and note the important information.

2 Introductory explanations

The "LayerConvert" plugin allows you to automate recurring command sequences, even for multiple drawings. A typical example would be if you have a profile library or symbol library where each profile cross-section or symbol is saved in a separate file. If you need to edit these files, you might be forced to open, edit, save, and then close hundreds of drawings in AutoCAD.

The LayerConvert plugin helps you here because you can order a wide variety of transformations for many files at once.

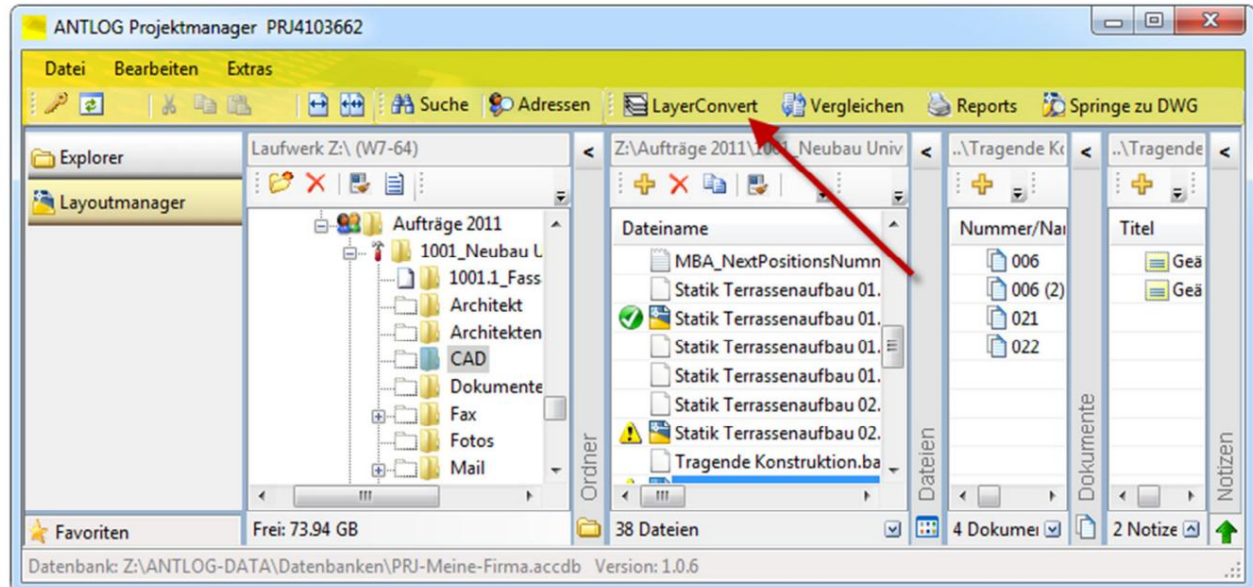
Likewise, a few drawings may require a large number of objects to be edited. For example, AutoCAD drawings may have been saved in DWG format from other CAD programs. In such cases, all objects are located on layer "0" but have different colors as object overrides. The LayerConvert plugin can then sort all of these objects by color and assign them to different layers according to your specifications. You can also commission this work for multiple drawings at once.

Another advantage is that the LayerConvert plugin works within an open AutoCAD session. This ensures fast and consistent execution. Typical script applications, Available for download on the Internet perform a similar function, but they require AutoCAD to be opened and then closed for each drawing file. This results in a very long processing time.

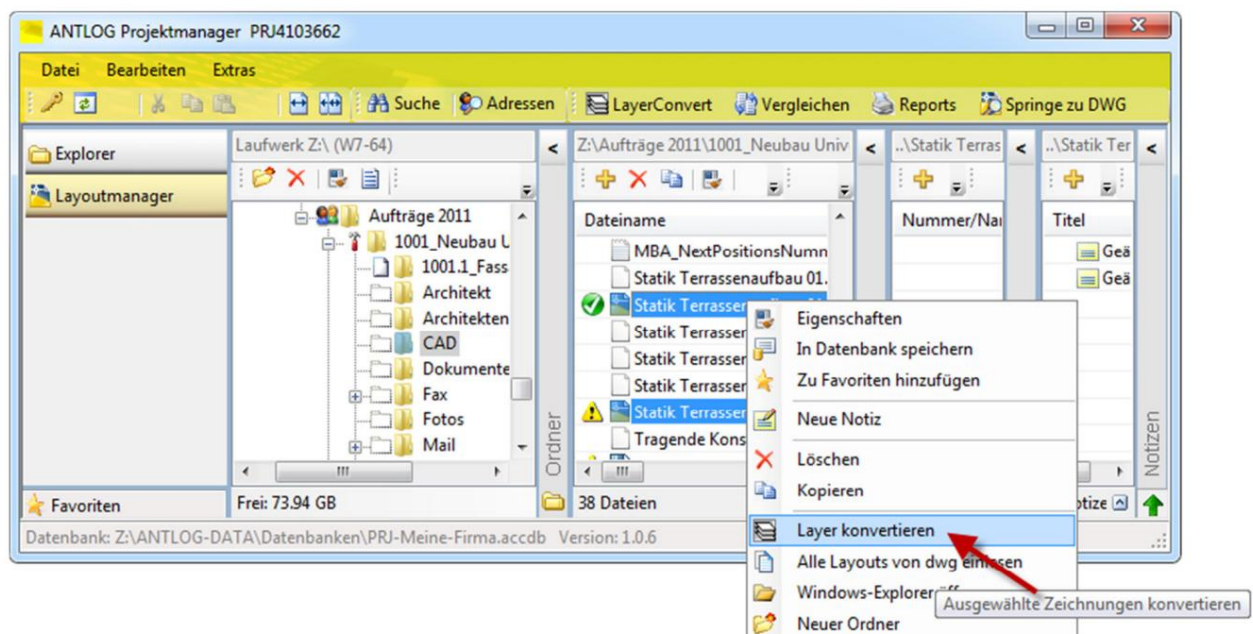
3 Configuration and call of the conversion

The layer conversion program can be used in two steps.

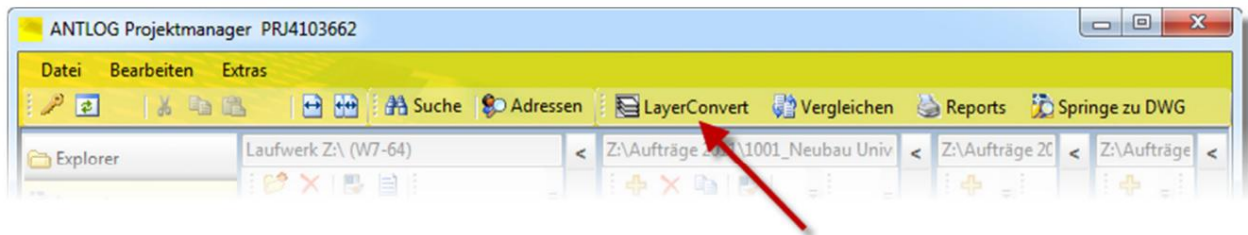
1. First, define the transformation steps in the "LayerConvert" command



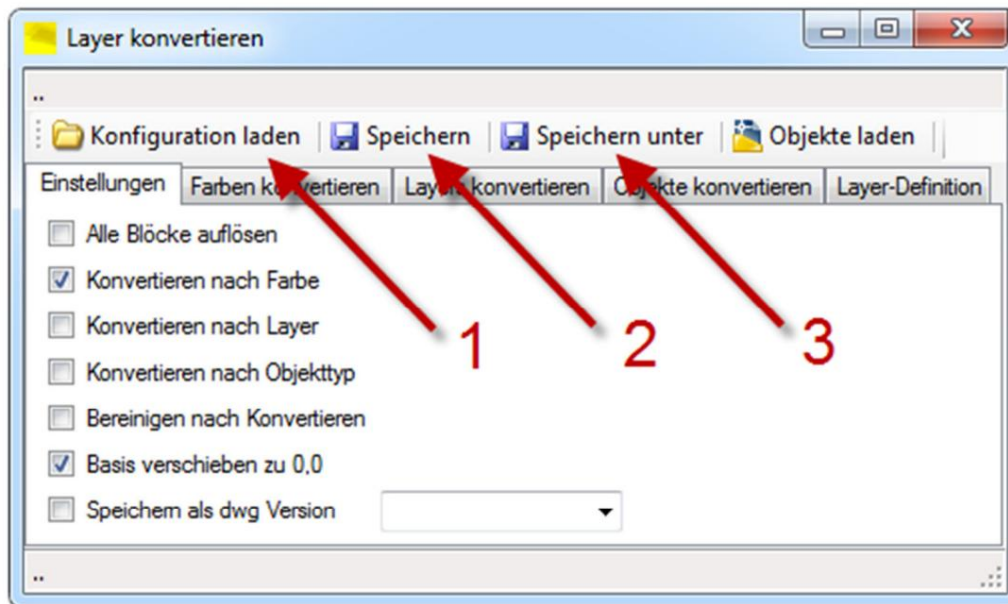
2. In the second step, you can perform this conversion for individual or multiple files by selecting all the files you want to converge, right-clicking, and selecting the "Convert Layer" command from the context menu. (For multiple selections, use the Windows keyboard shortcuts "Ctrl" or "Shift".)



3.1 Configuring a conversion If plugins are activated, the command "LayerConvert" also appears, which you can use to call up the configuration a conversion.



You will then be taken to the following dialog:



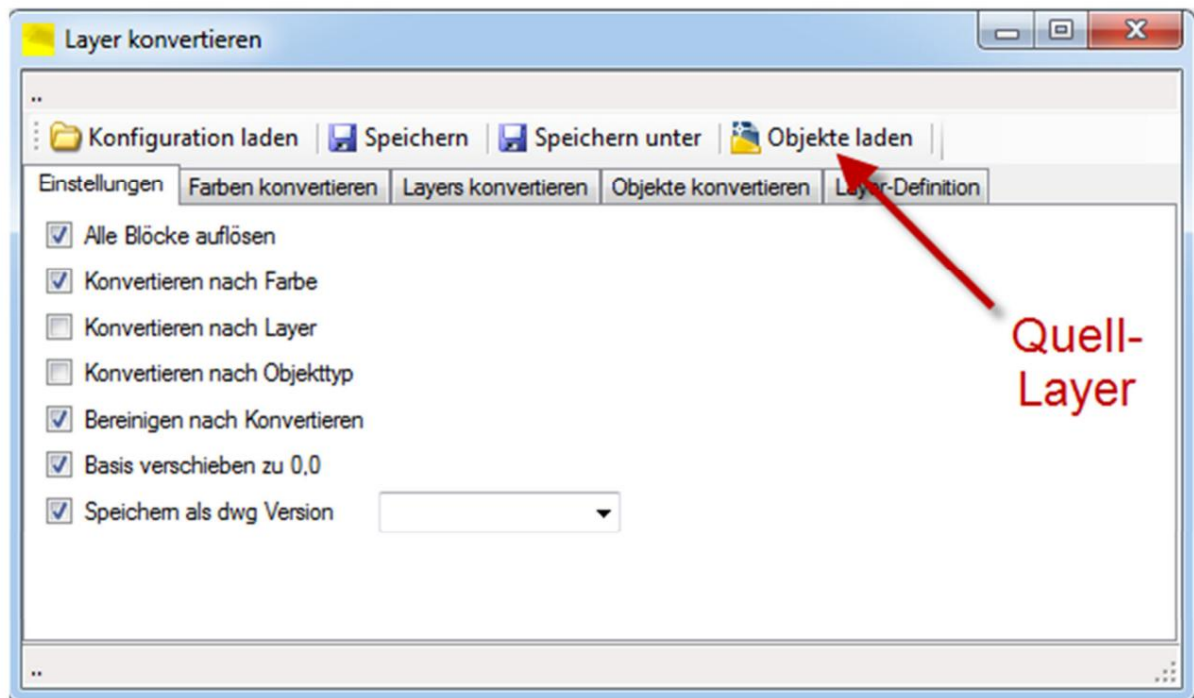
The first thing to note here is that all settings in this dialog must be saved in a separate file with the extension *.aclx.

- With "Load configuration" you can call up an already saved setting (arrow 1)
- With "Save" you can save the settings again under the existing name (arrow 2)
- With "Save as" you have the option of saving your settings under a new name to save (arrow 3)

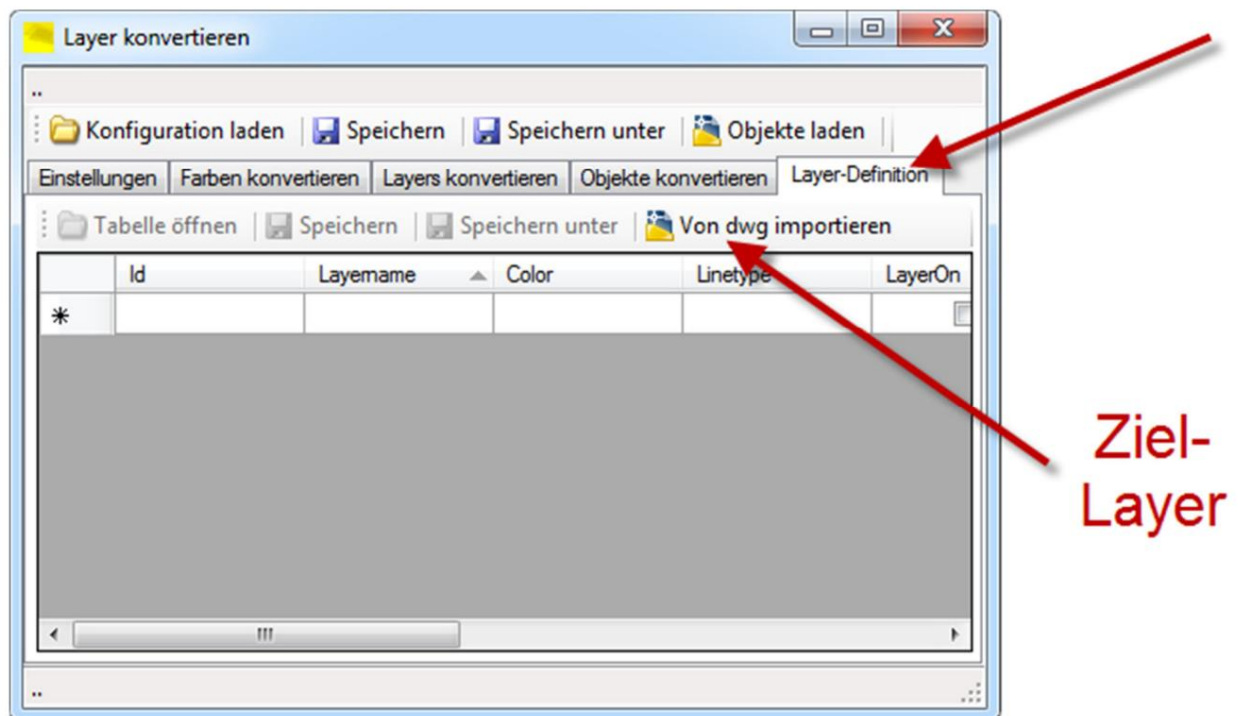
Note: If available, load an existing configuration file. If such a file doesn't exist, use the "Save As" command and save your settings first. You can then make changes to the settings, but don't forget to save these changes again before closing this dialog.

3.2 Loading Layers from Source Files and Target Layers Many settings of the

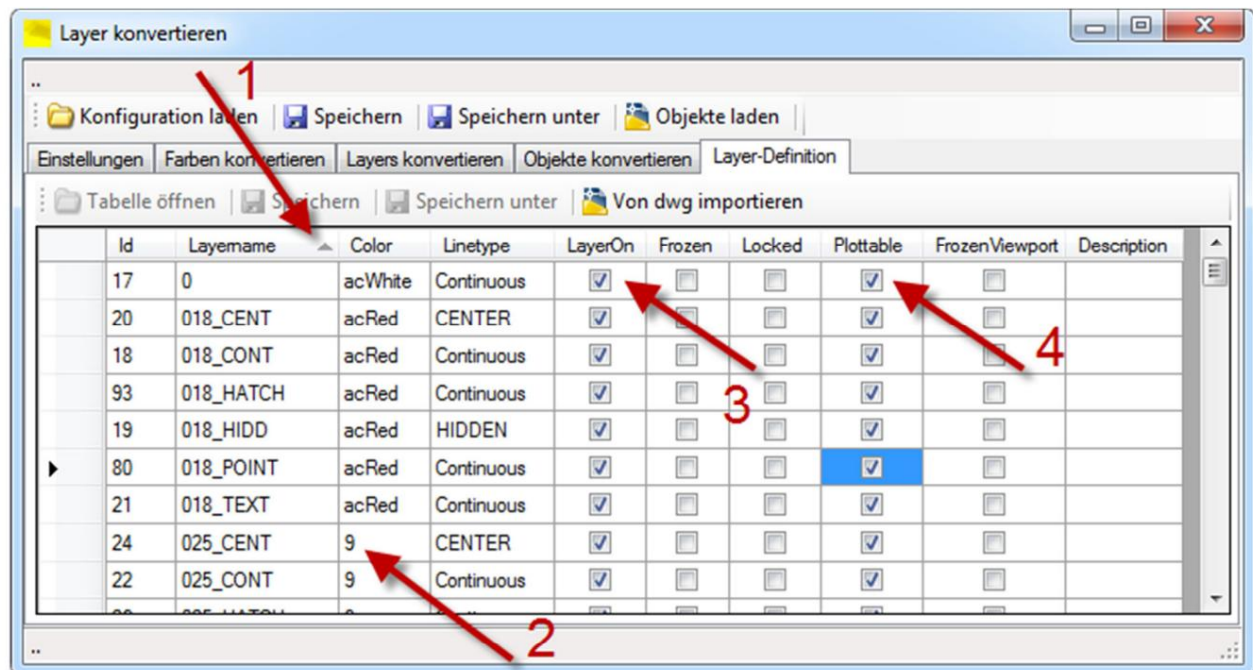
LayerConvert plugin—such as layer conversion—can only be configured if layers have been imported. Therefore, it is necessary to load at least one typical drawing whose layers are to be converted. We will refer to this drawing as the source drawing. You can do this with the "Load Objects" command.



Additionally, the target layers—the layers onto which the objects are to be placed—must also be included in the list. These layers are naturally located in another drawing. In the "Layer Definition" tab, you can use the "Import from DWG" command to load a drawing containing the desired target layers.



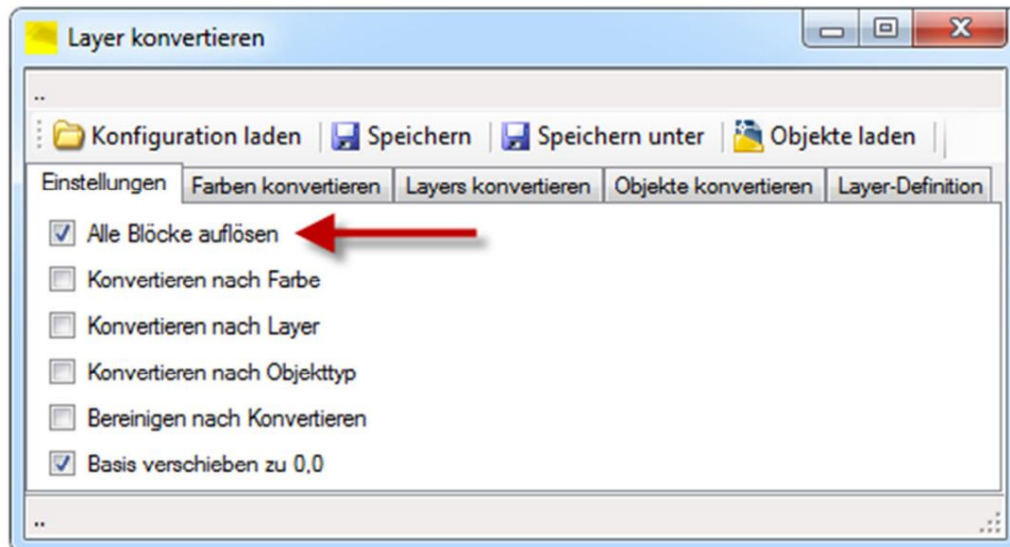
However, it may still be necessary to make some corrections. In such a case, you can edit the properties of the imported layers by double-clicking in a cell
Afterwards, the layer name, for example, can still be corrected.



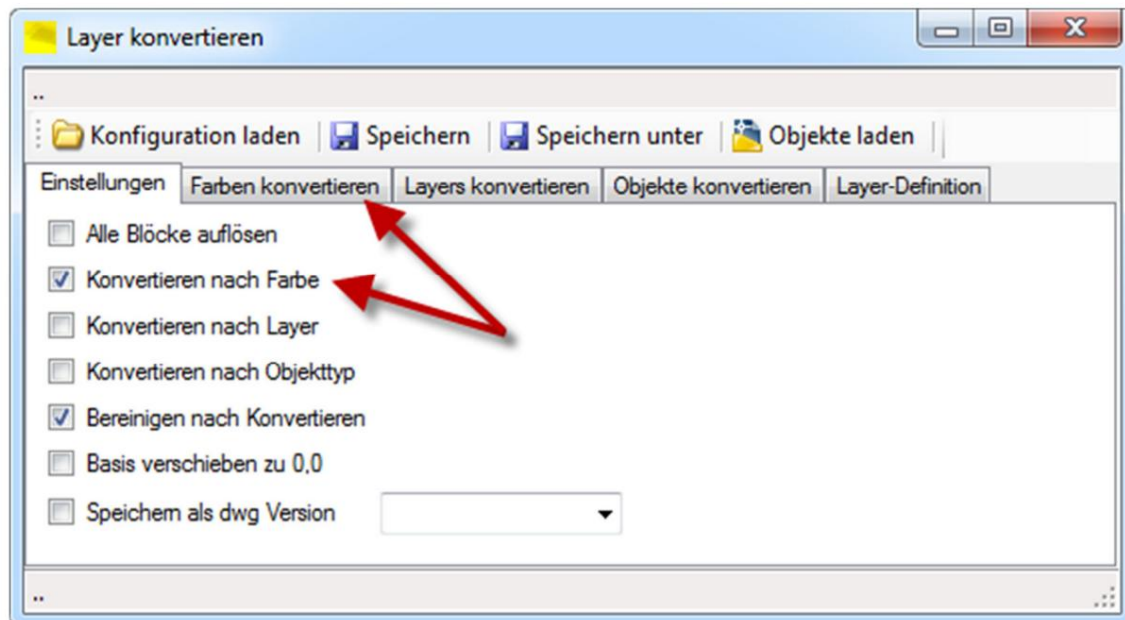
- By clicking on the column heading, you can list the column entries alphabetically. (Arrow 1)
- In the "Color" column you can change the color of the target layer.
Note: Here, the entry "acRed" stands for the primary color red. However, the color number "1" would be equally suitable for red. The designation "acColor" is only available for colors 1-7.
Other colors can only be designated by the color number. (Arrow 2)
- In this table, you can also decide whether the respective layer should be enabled after conversion. (Arrow 3) • The layer property "Print" is also important. For viewports, for example, the setting "Do Not Print" is suitable. (Arrow 4)

3.3 Resolve all blocks

"Explode all blocks" means that all blocks in the drawing are selected and exploded once using the "Origin" command. However, nested blocks are not exploded. If there is a block within a block, only the outermost block is exploded once. Please keep in mind that blocks in the layouts are also exploded, and this could inadvertently delete attribute entries in a title block.



3.4 Converting by color



This option must be enabled so that the settings defined under the "Convert Colors" tab are actually implemented.

Note: If multiple conversion steps are activated – i.e., "Convert by Color," then "Convert by Layer," and finally "Convert by Object Type," the tasks will be processed in that order. However, please note that objects have already been converted to a target layer during "Convert by Color" and are therefore not available for the

For the affected objects, a further "Convert by Layer" would make little sense. Likewise, in most cases, "Convert by Layer" followed by "Convert by Object Type" will be of little use, since the source layer is irrelevant in "Convert by Object Type," and therefore the target layer is determined solely by the settings in the "Convert by Object Type" tab.

After switching to the "Convert Colors" tab, you can assign colors to all the colors that appear in the sample drawing. • As can be seen in this example, all objects assigned color 1 (red)

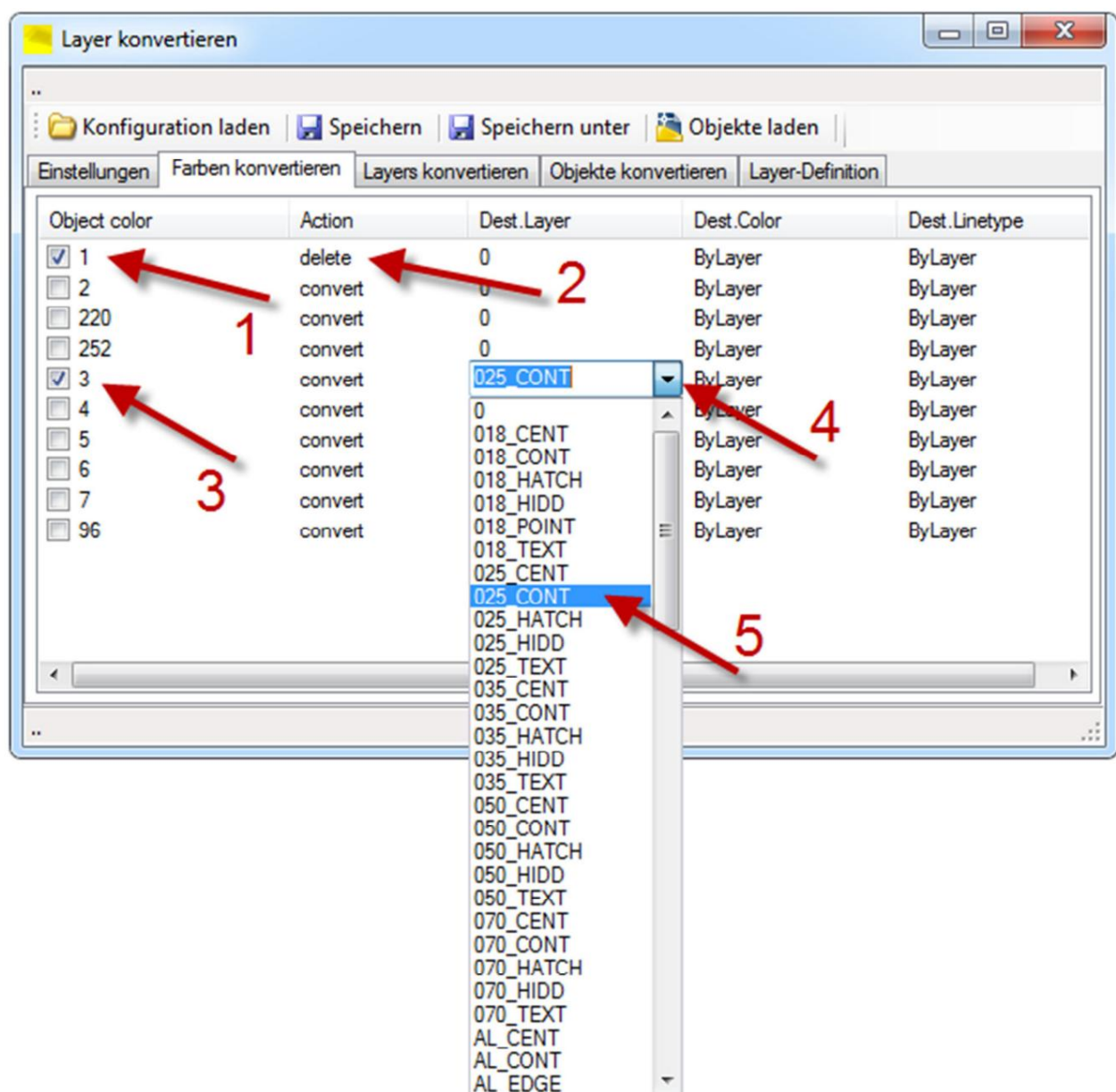
should be deleted. (Arrows 1 and 2)

Note: Only objects with the color red will be converted or deleted. Objects that get their color from a layer have the color "ByLayer" and are therefore NOT included.

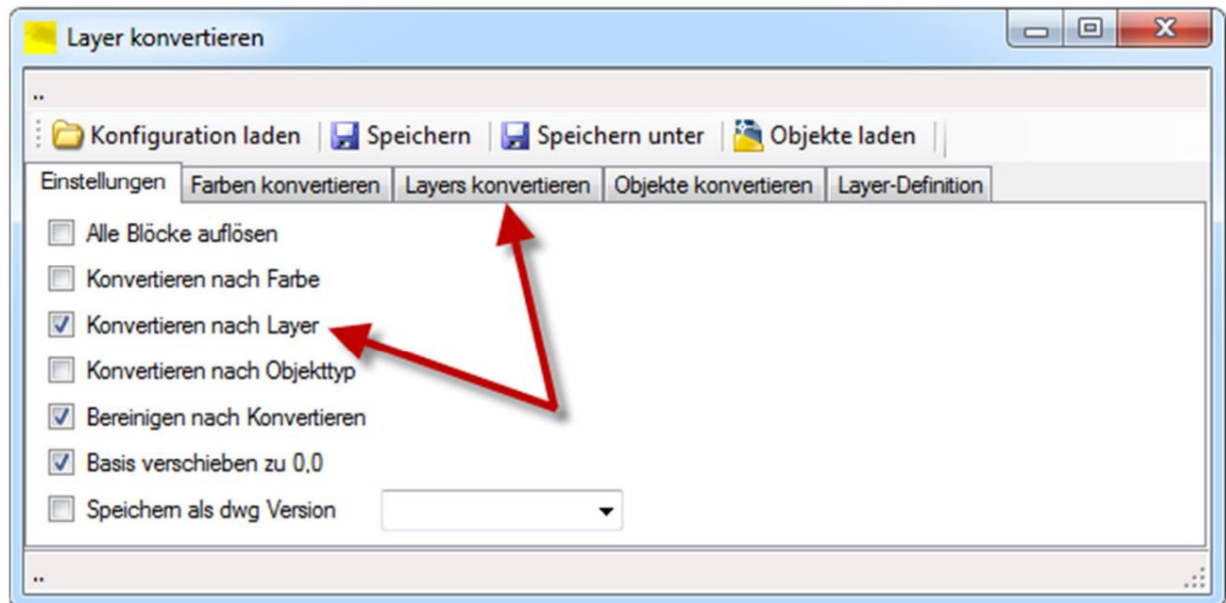
Editing a color must be confirmed by checking the box. Colors without a check mark will not be edited.

- Arrow 3 shows that all objects that have the color 3 (green) are converted.

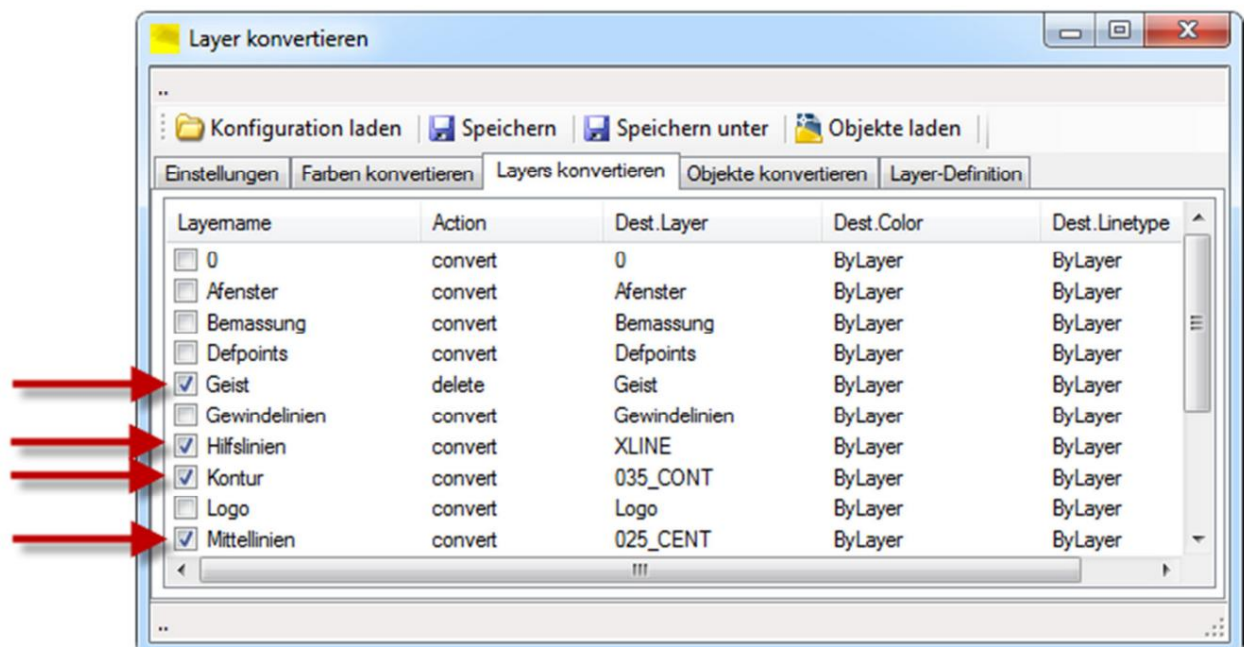
All green objects are placed on the layer "025_CONT." This selection was achieved by activating the scroll window (arrow 4) and selecting the correct layer (arrow 5).



3.5 Converting by Layer If you want to convert all objects that are located on a specific layer, then we recommend "Convert to Layer." This process must also first be enabled on the first "Settings" tab.

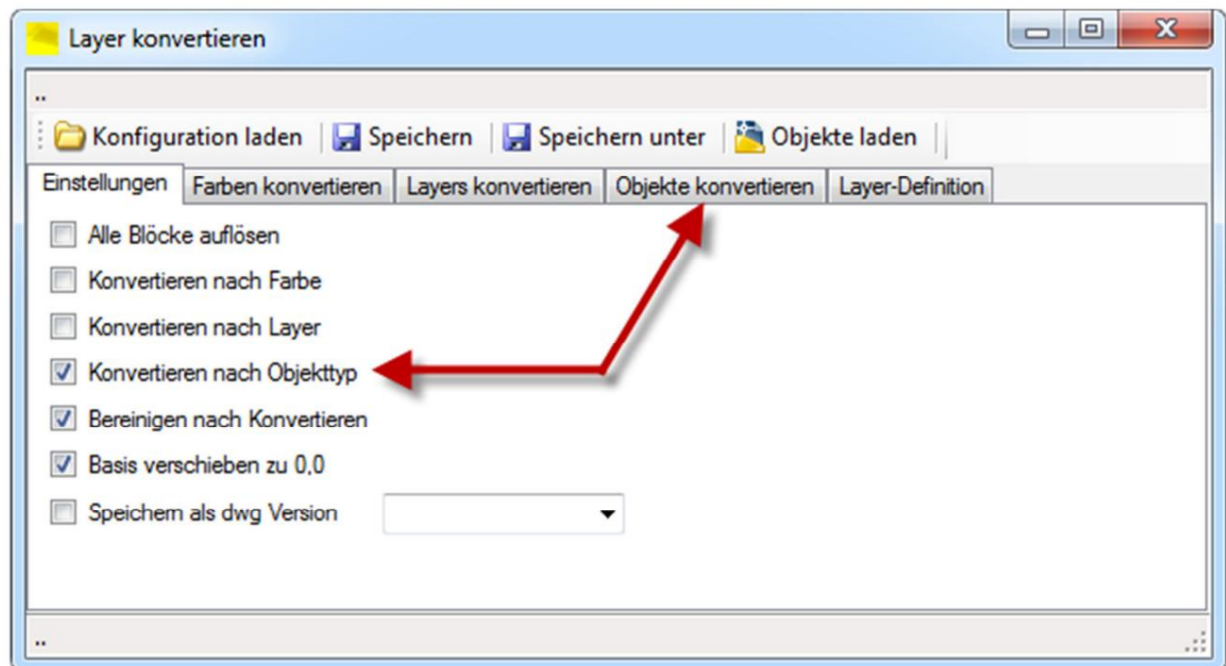


The correct assignments can then be made in the "Convert Layers" tab. • In our example, all objects located on the "Ghost" layer should be deleted. • Objects on the "Guide Lines" layer should be placed on the "XLINE" layer. • Objects on the "Contour" layer should be assigned to the "035_CONT" layer. • Finally, the "Centerlines" layer should be converted to "025_CENT".

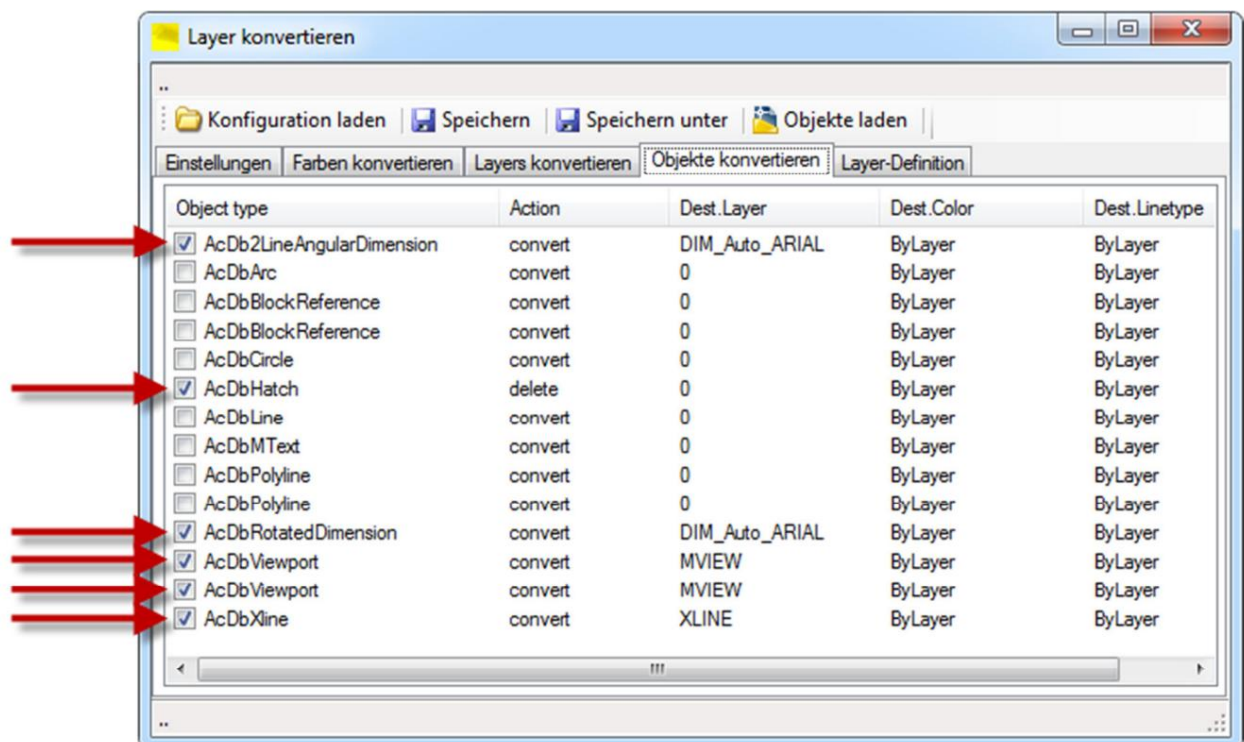


3.6 Converting by object type As with other conversion

tasks, converting by object type requires that this option be enabled under the "Settings" tab.



You can then make the appropriate settings.



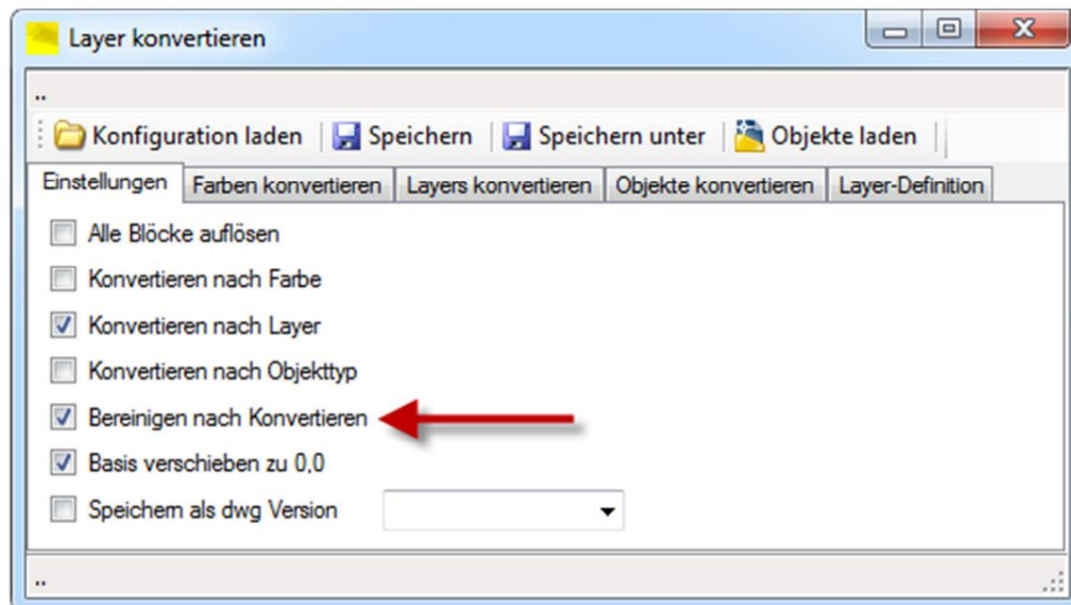
The listed entries correspond to the names of the individual classes in the AutoCAD database.

AcDb2LineAngularDimension	=	Angular dimensioning
AcDbArc	=	The book
AcDbBlockReference	=	Block
AcDbCircle	=	Circle
AcDbHatch	=	hatching
AcDbLine	=	line
AcDbMText	=	Paragraph text
AcDbPolyline	=	polyline
AcDbRotatedDimension	=	Rotated dimensioning
AcDbViewport	=	Viewport
AcDbXline	=	Construction line

- As can be seen in our example, all angular dimensions should be assigned to the "DIM_Auto_ARIAL" layer.
- All hatches should be deleted.
- Rotated dimensions should also be assigned to the "DIM_Auto_ARIAL" layer.
- Viewports should be assigned the "MVIEW" layer, and
- all construction lines should be placed on the "XLINE" layer.

3.7 Clean up after conversion

With this option you can ensure that all drawings that have been converged are also cleaned up at the end.

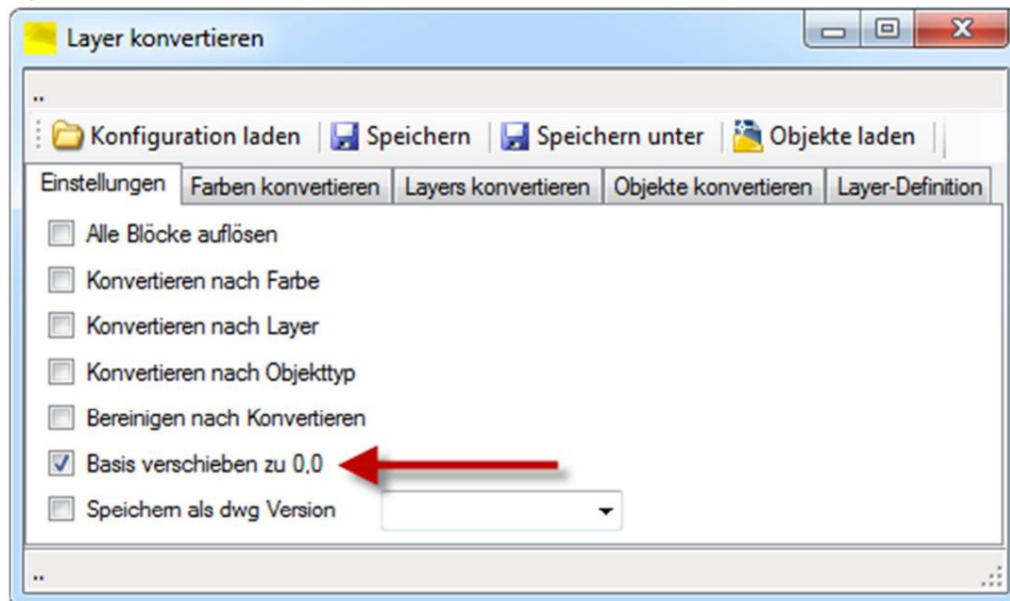


Note: All unused layers, text styles, dimension styles, linetypes, and blocks will be deleted from the drawing. Nested blocks, however, will not be cleaned up. Therefore, if blocks are defined within blocks and these also need to be cleaned up, the layer conversion would have to be performed twice using the "Clean Up" option.

3.8 Shift Base to 0.0 When inserting an

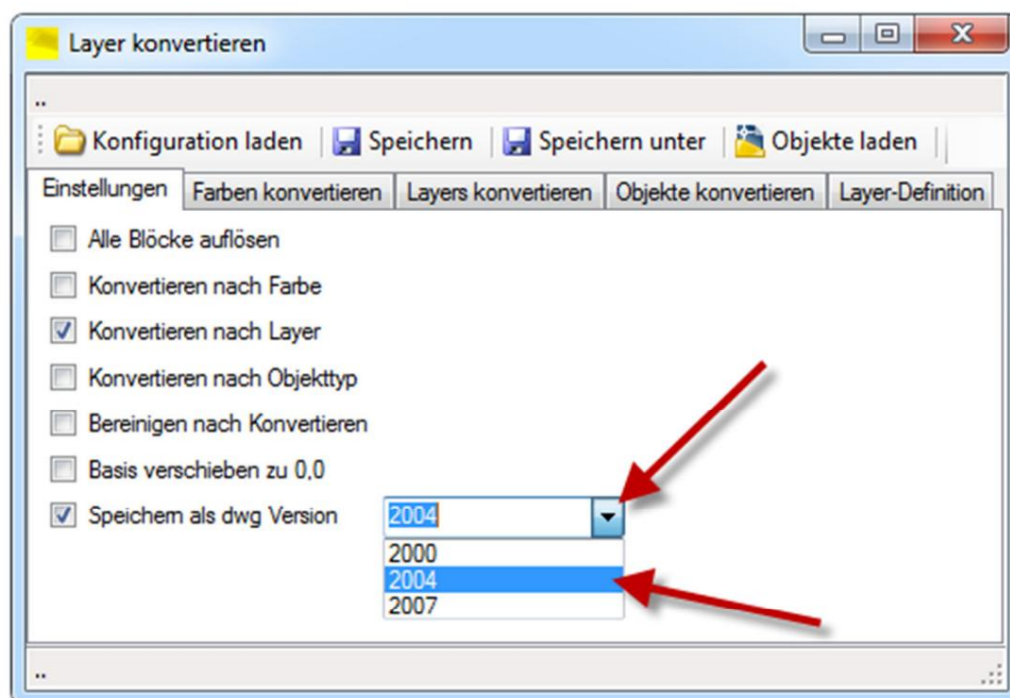
entire DWG file as a block in AutoCAD, the insertion point of this block is usually the world coordinate origin—that is, 0,0—of the inserted drawing. However, this only applies to drawings whose block base is also set to the world coordinate origin. If you execute the "Base" command in a drawing, you can define the insertion point anywhere in the drawing. However, this does not shift the entire geometry of the drawing in the world coordinate origin; it can still be located far away from 0.0.

This can now be done with the LayerConvert plugin's "Move Base to 0,0" command. It selects the point defined as the base and moves it to 0,0. Additionally, all objects in the model space of this drawing are selected and moved by the same vector as the base point. The result is that all objects and the base insertion point are positioned near the origin. lay.



3.9 Save as dwg version With this setting

you can specify in which dwg version the drawings should be saved after conversion



Note: To get a selection display with this option, layers must already be read in. If necessary, load some layers using the "Load Objects" command.